
Preface

This book develops a formal mathematical framework for analyzing systems of oppression using set theory, discrete mathematics, electrodynamics, and historical analysis. Its central claim is that racism cannot be reduced to a loose collection of bad attitudes or an inevitable expression of human nature. Racism functions as **psycho-legal social software**: legal, institutional, cultural, and affective code that runs on human predictive cognition—the **wetware** substrate on which that software executes—causing engineered partitions to execute as perception, common sense, threat detection, and selective empathy. Running in parallel to this software layer is a **hardware layer**: an electrodynamic formalism that treats the five-tier hierarchy as a circuit topology, the suppression allocation as a complex power signal, and reform shocks as inductive kickback, unifying every equation in the book into a single coherent physical system. Within that hardware layer, the material-wage electric field resolves into a vector superposition of discrete material wages indexed by intersection: a racial material wage, a gendered material wage, a class material wage—each coupling its own axis of privilege to the same extraction circuit. In racism’s case, that software is a legally engineered racial partition that exploits ordinary human cognition, recruits predictive shortcuts into racial priors, and turns those priors into a durable extraction system.

A critical architectural clarification: the Elite (E) do not *supply* the energy that drives this system. They *gate* it. The kinetic labor, taxes, and physical output of the Out-group and the Buffer Class constitute the actual power supply (V_{cc}) of the extraction circuit. The Elite function as a parasitic control layer—a transistor base receiving only a trickle of control current (laws, algorithms, media narratives) while dictating how the massive power of the masses is routed. The police, courts, and carceral apparatus that enforce the partition are paid for with wealth extracted from the very populations they patrol. The system is a self-exciting generator: it uses a portion of its own extracted output to power the interference engine that keeps the machine spinning. This means the architecture is not powered by independent Elite energy; it is powered by *your* compliance, and it dies when that compliance is withdrawn.

A note on terms and host wetware. The words **In-group** and **Out-group** are standard social-psychological terms before they are formal variables in this book. In APA Dictionary usage, an ingroup is a group to which a person belongs or with which the person

identifies; an outgroup is a group to which the person does not belong or with which the person does not identify; and ingroup bias names the tendency to favor one's own group relative to other groups American Psychological Association 2026a; American Psychological Association 2026c; American Psychological Association 2026b. Social Identity Theory then explains why these categories matter: the mind rapidly distinguishes “us” from “them” to manage trust, threat, cooperation, belonging, and self-concept Tajfel and Turner 1979. In this book's computing analogy, that sorting tendency is part of the human host wetware. The brain is a predictive, pattern-compressing neural network optimized for survival under uncertainty, not a neutral database optimized for truth under adversarial input. What once functioned as useful legacy code for small-group survival becomes a vulnerability when legal and social systems feed it malicious priors. Racism, in this framework, is the exploit: **psycho-legal social software** that installs a racial partition into ordinary predictive cognition and makes the partition feel like perception.

The operating name for that exploit is the **fractal mind virus**. It is “fractal” because the same partition-and-extraction logic reproduces at every scale: the empire, the nation, the city, the school district, the household, the ballot line, and the private reflex of suspicion. It is a “mind virus” because the legal code does not remain outside the person. It installs priors into human predictive cognition until the host experiences an engineered hierarchy as common sense. The book therefore tracks two coupled runtimes throughout: institutional code executing through law, property, policing, and finance; and cognitive code executing on human host wetware through fear, status, disgust, loyalty, and selective empathy.

The formal terms used later compress that psychological substrate into structural roles. **In-group** means the population the system marks as relatively protected, legitimate, or entitled to status inside a given partition. **Out-group** means the population marked as extractable, controllable, or disposable. These are structural positions, not moral identities or biological categories; a person can be advantaged along one axis and subordinated along another. The **Elite** is the small subset of the In-group that actually benefits from the extraction system; the **Buffer Class** is the broader In-group layer recruited to defend the partition in exchange for status, selective protection, or occasional material concessions; the **Puppet Class** translates Elite preference into law and policy; and the **Enforcement Class** physically actuates those policies. The notation introduced later simply lets those recurring roles be tracked precisely.

The framework identifies four architectural components common to oppressive systems: (1) asymmetric autonomy restriction between In-groups and Out-groups, (2) selective empathy that validates In-group suffering while dismissing Out-group harm, (3) ideological justification through spurious claims, and (4) resistance to structural critique. These

components operate through a five-tier hierarchy. The Elite (E) extracts value; the Puppet Class (P_{uppet}) translates extraction into law and policy; the Enforcement Class (F_{enforce}) actuates the system physically; the Buffer Class (I_{buffer}) receives a suppression allocation in exchange for policing the partition; and the Out-group ($O_{\text{racialized}}$) bears the compounding burden of extraction.

Before the historical timeline begins, **Chapter 0: System Initialization** compiles the abstract geometry of the trap: the five structural nodes (E , P_{uppet} , F_{enforce} , I_{buffer} , O), their arrangement as a 3-D pyramid rather than a flat 2-D triangle, the Tri-Modal Enclosure Model that prevents the Out-group from stepping outside that pyramid to perceive its own architecture, and the optical illusion—Elite Obscuration and the Square Ceiling—that makes the apex invisible from the base. Chapter 1 then loads racism as the primary empirical dataset: defining the software before running its execution history. The historical compile begins in Chapter 2 and is instantiated on American wetware in Chapter 3.

This framework did not arrive fully formed. It began as hand-written summations of the familiar two-tier binary—Oppressor versus Oppressed. The equations broke. The model expanded to three tiers to account for the Elite’s separation from the broader In-group. Three tiers broke. The law required a Puppet Class; the carceral state required an Enforcement Class. The five-tier architecture is therefore not an imposed theoretical preference. It is the minimum configuration the mathematics required to remain internally consistent with the historical record.

Reader Diagnostic: Veil of Ignorance and Radical Empathy

As you move through this framework, practice what John Rawls called the **Veil of Ignorance**: evaluate the system from an “original position” in which you do not know which tier you will occupy Rawls 1971. Rawls built this thought experiment on Kantian moral foundations, but its use here is diagnostic rather than prescriptive. Its practical discipline is **radical empathy**: a positional stress test in which the reader places themselves inside each tier of the architecture— E , P_{uppet} , F_{enforce} , I_{buffer} , and O —while temporarily stripping away the knowledge of where they actually stand. Radical empathy is not excuse-making and it is not moral neutrality. It does not ask the reader to absolve harm. It asks the reader to model the incentives, risks, fears, rewards, and constraints that each tier imposes on the person trapped inside it.

The diagnostic question is simple: if you had no clue which tier you would wake up in, would you co-sign this architecture? If the answer is no, then welcome to the club. The work is not to prove that one’s own tier is innocent. The work is to

dismantle the architecture that makes innocence structurally unavailable.

That sequence matters because the book defines racism by tracing the life cycle of an extraction algorithm. **Part I** (*Specification and Origins, 1440s–1787*) establishes the template: the racial vector invented in Zurara’s 1453 *Crónica* (Chapter 2), the Buffer Class formalized after Bacon’s Rebellion, and the Puppet Class prototyped at the Constitutional Convention (Chapter 3). **Part II** (*The Installation, 1619–1865*) builds the on-premise machinery: the colonial extraction of African kinship (Chapter 5), the gendered reproductive kernel of coverture and eugenics (Chapter 6), and the slave-patrol genealogy that compounds into the 13th Amendment loophole (Chapter 7). **Part III** (*Scaling and Runtime, 1865–Present*) shows the algorithm executing at industrial scale: spatial containment and the Capture Variable (Chapter 8), the industrialized Puppet Class and the Tweedism Filter on democracy (Chapter 12), the post-*Brown* Variable Swap and the 1968–1994 recompile (Chapter 13), the terminal runtime of cannibalization and the 5-Tier Reveal (Chapter 14), and the kinetic guarantee that stands between the algorithm and completion (Chapter 16). **Part IV** (*Diagnostics and Output*) produces the framework’s terminal findings: the Concession Theorem (Chapter 17), the global containment field (Chapter 18), and the revised, vector-valued definition of racism that closes the book (Chapter 23).

The through-line is expansion. Tracing the algorithm from Portuguese racialization through the invention of whiteness, the 13th Amendment loophole, redlining, the War on Drugs, and the present-day cannibalization of the In-group reveals that the Out-group targeted by systemic oppression *expands* over time, progressively encompassing groups once protected by the In-group boundary. This expansion shows that oppressive systems do not ultimately serve the nominal In-group. They serve an Elite class ($E \subset I$) that uses division to prevent solidarity.

In plain terms, this is the old strategy of divide and conquer rendered as an engineering problem. The set-theoretic model formalizes *how* division is manufactured: the Elite partitions the population along available axes—race, gender, class, religion, identity—and tunes those partitions to interfere destructively with one another, preventing unified class solidarity from achieving coherent amplitude. The result is a population that can be politically hyperactive while remaining structurally inert: fully engaged in N competing conflicts, none of which touch the extraction kernel. Every chapter traces a different mechanism by which that division is manufactured, maintained, and repaired when it begins to fail. The purpose of the formalism is to make the machine visible enough to disable.

Empirical validation. The formal claims in this book are not left as unanchored abstractions. Every equation and structural assertion is assigned a confidence tier (Tier 1: peer-reviewed quantitative; Tier 2: public dataset with disclosed computation; Tier 3: ordinal or structural estimate) and a falsification criterion. The calibration rests on 146 anchor cases spanning 146 historical events; each case is documented with its data sources, operationalisation procedure, and the conditions under which the structural claim it validates would be falsified. A complete per-equation index—mapping each equation to its confidence tier, primary data source, and falsification criterion—is compiled in Appendix E.3. The Empirical Methodology chapter (p. lv) details the anchor-and-scale procedure, the sociological precedent for ordinal composite scoring, and the reproducibility standard applied uniformly across all three tiers.